

and hence had a keen interest in its growth. Trouble started in 1998 with The Open Group's release of an X Server version called X11R6.4, which had a radical change in its Licensing Policy. The X Server suddenly seemed more proprietary than open source, beating the very intent of the original X Consortium. However, The Open Group claimed it needed assured funding to keep the development of X going.

Another group, called the Xfree86, originated in 1992, which again was formed after a dispute over another proprietary X Server. An X Server, X386 1.2E was being made into a proprietary software which led purists to form the Xfree86, somewhat as a dig on the X386 name.

Now, it so happens that the Xfree86 also disagreed with The Open Group for the latter's proprietary attempts. This forced The Open Group to continue distributing the X Server under the original, more liberal licensing policy.

The Open Group founded X.Org in 1999, in an attempt at gaining some technical inputs. Most of the development that had happened since the dissolution of the original X Consortium had come from Xfree86, and so Xfree86 was invited to join the X.Org as an honorary non-paying member.

However, things were not all too well within Xfree86. As Linux's popularity grew post-2000, and as did the demand for X Servers, Xfree86 had built a reputation of not being a pure open source group—the source code between versions was not available to the public, only the final source code was. This placed almost complete control of the development of X in the hands of the Xfree86 group. After much debate, Keith Packard, who had joined XFree86 after the end of the original MIT X Consortium, was expelled from Xfree86.

Moving towards a full commitment to open source, Xfree86 and X.Org looked towards the development of X and formed the